

Ruhe Global Resources

Internal Correspondence · Engineering / HR

DATE	15 September 2026
TO	Mrs Georgian — Human Resources, Ruhe Global Resources
FROM	David — Developer, Ruhe Global Resources
CC	Mr Joseph — CEO (for awareness)
SUBJECT	Findings from audit of accommodationfinders.co.uk & role alignment

Dear Mrs Georgian,

I'm writing to formally document findings from the technical audit I conducted on the Accommodation Finders website (<https://accommodationfinders.co.uk/>) which was handed to me today, and to request a conversation about how my role aligns with what was agreed during my interview with Mr Joseph.

1. Context — what was agreed at interview

During my interview with Mr Joseph, I was asked to propose a solution for the current company website at <https://ruhegr.com/>. My recommendation was clear and is on record: build a **modern, fast and responsive** web platform using Next.js, with source control on GitHub and deployment via Vercel. That recommendation was accepted as the direction of travel, and it formed the basis of my joining Ruhe Global Resources.

To date — one and a half weeks in — I have not been assigned to that work. I have instead been producing social media content, which I have gladly done and will continue to do, given my background in AI-assisted video generation. However, I understand that another developer, Ifeanyi, has since been brought onboard and is now executing the Next.js build I had originally scoped with Mr Joseph. I have no issue with Ifeanyi personally; I simply wish to flag the inconsistency.

Today, I was instead handed a WordPress install (<https://accommodationfinders.co.uk/>) to develop further. I was left a little bit disappointed when I inquired if I could begin developing the website with my preferred tool stack and was met with a rejection. I want to be transparent: this is not work I am able to take on, and the reasons are technical, not preferential. I have documented them below.

2. Findings from the audit of accommodationfinders.co.uk

I spent approximately thirty minutes auditing the live site. The findings are as follows.

2.1 The site is live and serving real traffic while still under development

The site is publicly accessible at production URL with no staging environment, no preview deployment, and no access control. **This poses a significant security risk.** HTTP response on 15 September 2026:

```
HTTP/1.1 200 OK
Server: Apache
X-Powered-By: PHP/8.4.25
Host: wghp5.wghservers.com (Secured Servers LLC, Virginia, US)
```

This is the single most important finding. **A site that is under active development should not be receiving real production traffic.** Standard practice is to develop against a local or staging environment, deploy to a preview URL for review, and only promote to production once content, performance and security have been signed off. The current arrangement exposes unfinished work, internal structure and plugin fingerprints to the public — including potential attackers — throughout the entire development cycle.

2.2 No version control, no CI/CD, no preview pipeline

There is no Git repository behind this site. Source code lives only on the production server's filesystem, and content lives in the MySQL database. Concretely, this means:

- There is no history of changes, so no audit trail of who changed what and when.
- There is no way to roll back to a known-good state other than restoring a database backup.
- There is no way to preview a change before it reaches live users — every save in Elementor is published instantly.
- There is no automated testing, no build verification, no deployment gate.

For a business processing accommodation bookings (which involve personal data and payment-related flows), the absence of these safeguards is not a stylistic preference — it is a material risk.

2.3 Stack fingerprint and plugin composition

Component	Value
CMS	WordPress
Page builder	Elementor (visual drag-and-drop)
Theme	Hello Elementor (Elementor's starter theme)
Booking engine	MotoPress Hotel Booking Lite — free hotel plugin, repurposed for student housing
Header / footer	“Header Footer Builder for Elementor” (third-party addon)
Hosting	Shared / VPS — Secured Servers LLC, Virginia
PHP version	8.4.25
Analytics	None detected — no GA4, no Meta Pixel, no Plausible
Custom code	Effectively zero — all functionality is plugin configuration stored in the database

2.4 Performance and payload

The homepage returns approximately 120 KB of HTML on every request, of which a significant proportion is inline `<style>` blocks generated by Elementor per page. Because there is no build step, this CSS is regenerated on each request and cannot benefit from a build-time optimisation pass. For comparison, a properly built Next.js application serving equivalent content typically returns 40–50 KB with code-split, tree-shaken, cached assets.

There is also no edge caching, no CDN in front of the origin, and no image optimisation pipeline.

2.5 Information exposure and security posture

The site exposes, by default:

- WordPress version and plugin paths in page source (`/wp-content/plugins/elementor/...`)
- PHP version via the **X-Powered-By** header

- wp-json REST API endpoints at the public URL, which can be enumerated by anyone
- No **Content-Security-Policy**, no **Strict-Transport-Security** preload, no **X-Frame-Options: DENY**

Each of these is a low-severity issue in isolation, but together they describe a site that was deployed with default settings and never hardened. This is normal for WordPress installs; it is not normal for a production booking platform handling personal data.

3. Why I am not able to take this work on

I want to be direct here, because I respect Mrs Georgian's time and Mr Joseph's original brief.

WordPress development as a discipline is not aligned with my professional skills, and choosing it for a new build in 2026 would, in my honest assessment, not serve Ruhe Global Resources well. The reasons are concrete:

1. **It is not what I was hired to do.** The brief at interview was Next.js + GitHub + Vercel. I have not deviated from that brief; the project has.
2. **The toolchain does not support the engineering practices I consider non-negotiable** — typed code, AI-assisted development, version control, automated testing, preview environments, atomic deployments, observability. WordPress as a platform does not provide these by default and retrofitting them is more work than rebuilding.
3. **It is not the right tool for a booking platform handling personal data and payments.** The free MotoPress hotel plugin being used here is not designed for the regulatory and security requirements of UK student accommodation. A custom Next.js application with a properly typed backend gives the business control over data handling, audit logging, and compliance posture — which WordPress-with-plugins does not.
4. **Total cost of ownership is higher, not lower.** A WordPress site looks cheap to stand up, but the long-term cost — plugin subscriptions, security patching, recovery from incidents, developer onboarding for a stack that has no version control — is materially higher than a properly built custom application. I would be doing the company a disservice to pretend otherwise.

For context on what I am building day-to-day in the tool stack I do work in: I began developing <https://pitchcoachai.tech/> over the weekend out of a personal interest in integrating chatbots and AI agents into platforms. It is an AI pitch-coaching application built on Next.js, deployed on Vercel, with Clerk for authentication and Z.ai / Gemini for the language model layer. It is still in active development — the security layer does not yet let users past the sign-up page — but it is a small, representative example of the kind of platform I am equipped to ship, and this is the standard in 2026.

4. What I am asking for

I am not asking to be relieved of duties. I am asking for clarity on the following:

1. Is the Accommodation Finders project being handed to me to develop? If so, I would like to discuss whether a rebuild in the originally agreed stack is possible, rather than continuing to extend the current WordPress install.
2. If not, what is the intended scope of my role for the remainder of my probation? I am happy to continue content work in the interim, but I would like it on record that this is not the work I was hired to do.
3. If there are other web development opportunities within the company, or within partner and client relations, I would gladly take these on — as a caveat, it was clearly stated in the job description and offer letter I received from the organisation that this kind of work falls within my remit. I would also welcome

the opportunity to contribute to the Next.js work that Ifeanyi is leading; I would prefer collaboration over displacement.

I came to Ruhe Global Resources to be challenged and to do serious work. I am confident I can deliver against the original brief, and I would welcome the opportunity to do so. I am available to walk through any of the technical points above at your convenience.

Thank you for your time.

Kind regards,

David

Developer

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